Notes for Lecture two by Md Abdul Malak, PhD

The permanent settlement act -1793 (the sunset law)

- A contract between Zamindar and EIC controlled government of Bangal
- The Zamindar got the permanent ownership of land by paying a fix rate of revenue to EIC Government.
- Zamindars was allowed to fix taxes or revenue for their tenant (peasant) according to their wish
- The sunset law: If any Zamindar failed to pay annual revenue to EIC Government before the sunset of the last day, then the government has taken their land and sell it to new owner through open tender.
- Hundreds of Zamindars lost their state in this process.

Social Reform

The Education Act 1835

- The English Education Act 1835 was a legislative Act of the Council of India, gave effect to a decision in 1835 by Lord William Bentinck, then Governor-General of the British East India Company, to reallocate funds it was required by the British Parliament to spend on education and literature in India.
- To establish the supremacy of the western learning.
- British believe that English should be the only medium of education in India. This was making English the language of the nation.
- Incorporate English textbooks into school curriculum.
- To stop promoting oriental schools like the Calcutta Madrasa and the Benaras Sanskrit College.

Bengali Renaissance

- **Bengali Renaissance** was a cultural, social, intellectual, and artistic movement that took place in the region of the , from the late 18th century to the early 20th century.
- The movement questioned the existing customs and rituals in Indian society – most notably, the caste system, and the practice of sati, idolatry ( )– as well as the role of religion and colonial governance.
- The Bengali renaissance was predominantly led by , who at the time were socially and economically more affluent in colonial Bengal, and therefore better placed for higher education as a community.
- Well-known figures include the social reformer , writer , and the physicist
- The main Muslim figures in the movement include members of the , poet and musician and writer

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British India 1747-1857

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Topic Points

- British East India Company in India and growth of its power
- Battle of Polashi and it's aftermath
- Battle of Buxar 1764
- Diwani Rights to the British East India Company and its aftermat
- Permanent Settlement Act 1793
- Impact of Permanent Settlement
- Early Reforms and repercussions
- Early Resistance movement
- The First Indian War of Independence, 1857

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Topics to be covered:

- The Aftermath of the first war of independence (1857)
- Rise of nationalism and change in the British policy
- First partition of Bengal in 1905
- Swadeshi movement
- Electoral and administrative reforms

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- Often they gather five to six thousand fakir-sannyasis in one place to move. The number of fakirs and sannyasis rose to around fifty thousand or more in 1770s.
- After the death of Majnu Shah the movement was gradually losing its direction and dynamics. By the late 1790s, the revolt began to be subsided only to wither away in the form of stray resistance in the subsequent decade.

Titu Mir (Syed Mir Nisar Ali) -1782-1831

- **Titu Mir** (1782-1831) a peasant leader who resisted the oppression of the local zamindars and European indigo planters on the peasantry with ultimate object of liberating the country from British domination.
- He was a leader of the tariqah-i-muhammadiya in Bengal, and his movement initially aimed at socio-religious reforms, elimination of the practice of *shirk* (pantheism) and *bidat* (innovation) in the Muslim society and at inspiring the Muslims to follow Islamic principles in their day to day life.
- He built a strong fort with bamboo poles at Narkelbaria in October 1831, recruited mujahids and gave them military training. The number of Mujahids soon rose to nearly five thousand.
- Having completed his military preparation Titu Mir declared himself *Badshah* (king) and urged upon the people to participate in *jihad* (sacred war) against the British.
- He soon established his control over the districts of 24 Parganas, Nadia and Faridpur and demanded tax from the zamindars
- Zamindars seek help from British then an English contingent was sent from Calcutta. But the combined forces of the zamindars and the English contingent force defeated by *mujahids* (troops).
- Subsequently, Lord william bentinck sent a regular army against and launched attack on the mujahids on 14 November 1831.
- The mujahids with traditional weapons failed to resist the English army equipped with modern arms. Titu Mir along with many of his followers died in the battle (19 November 1831).

Indigo (নীল) Resistance Movement (1859-1862)

Santhal Rebellion (সাঁওতাল বিদ্রোহ)

First War of Independence, 1857 (সিপাহি বিপ্লব, ১৮৫৭)

- The Indian Rebellion of 1857 occurred as the result of an accumulation of factors over time, rather than any single event.
- The were Indian soldiers who were recruited into the Company's army. Just before the rebellion, there were over 300,000 sepoys in the army, compared to about 50,000 British.

Main achievement

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Aligarh Movement by Sir Syed Ahmed Khan.

The chief **Aligarh Movement objectives** included convincing the section of Muslim individuals to gain the recent English language and knowledge. The other objectives of the **Aligarh movement** include:

- To promote and maintain the economic and political significance of the Muslim community
- To build a sense of trust between the Muslim community and the government

Outcome of the Movement

- Many socio-religious movements grew in the 19th century as a result of the Aligarh movement.
- During the 20th century, the influence of this movement was visible in the other regions of the Indian sub-continent other than North India.
- The growth of institutes including Osmania University, Jamia Millia Islamia, Dacca University, and Aligarh Muslim University was promoted by the annual educational conferences that took place in different parts of the country

All India Muhammadan Education conference 1886

- All India Muslim Educational Conference (AIMEC), a Non-political organization which brought Muslims social and political leaders, intellectuals and distinguished people from all of walks of life onto one platform for educational empowerment of Muslims of India.

- It transformed the dimensions of Aligarh Movement and fulfilled the dream of its founder, Sir Syed Ahmad Khan by converting **Muhammadan Anglo Oriental College (M.A.O. College) to Aligarh Muslim University.**

- The Conference also became championing the cause of Women's education and gave birth to one of the oldest and biggest women's educational institution, **Women's College of Aligarh**.

- This non-political, All India Muslim Educational Conference which was started for educational empowerment of Muslims of India also gave birth to largest Muslim political party "**Muslim League**"

The main objectives of the Conference were:

- To provide a platform for Muslims to get higher education.
- To arrange a forum through which religious education should be taught in English medium schools of Muslims.
- To provide a forum for ullama and religious scholars to encourage diniyat and oriental studies in the schools of Muslims, and support them to take forward religious tasks.
- To provide a forum, through which the declined status of religious institutions should be improved.

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Main provisions of the Act:

- Increased non-official members in the council
  - Bombay - 8
  - Madras - 20
  - Bengal - 20
  - North-Western province -15
  - Oudh - 15
  - Central Legislative Council minimum - 10, maximum 16
- Members could **now debate the budget without having the ability to vote** on it also **barred from asking follow-up questions.**
- The **Governor-General in Council was given the authority** to set rules **for member nomination**, subject to the approval of the Secretary of State for India.
- Made a **limited and indirect provision for the use of election** in filling up **non-official seats both in central and provincial councils**
- **Nomination for non-official members to central legislative council (Bengal chamber of commerce**, governors for provincial legislative council based on **recommendation** of **district boards, municipalities, universities, trade associations, zamindars and chambers)**

Significance of the act:

- The Indian Councils Act, 1892 is a significant milestone in **India's constitutional and political history.**
- **The act increased the size of various legislative councils in India** thereby increasing the engagement of Indians with respect to the administration in British India.
- The Indian Councils Act, 1892 was the **first step towards the representative government in modern India.**
- The act created the stage **for the development of revolutionary forces in India** because the British only made a minor concession.

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First Partition of Bengal: 1905

- The government's decision to partition Bengal was made in December 1903. The official reason was that Bengal, with a population of 78 million, was too large to be administered; the real reason, however, was that it was the center of the revolt, and British officials could not control the protests, which they thought would spread throughout India.

Swadeshi Movement (1903-1905)

- The **Swadeshi movement** was a self-sufficiency movement that was part of the Indian independence movement and contributed to the development of Indian nationalism.
- Before the BML Government's decision for the partition of Bengal was made public in December 1903, there was a lot of growing discontentment among the Indians.
- In response the Swadeshi movement was formally started from Town Hall, Calcutta on 7 August 1905 to curb foreign goods by relying on domestic production.
- Mahatma Gandhi described it as the soul of swaraj (self-rule). The movement took its vast size and shape after rich Indians donated money and land dedicated to Khadi and Gramodyog societies which started cloth production in every household.
- It also included other village industries so as to make village self-sufficient and self-reliant.

The Morley-Minto Reforms, 1909 (Indian Council Act 1909)

Annulment of the Partition and its Impact

- In 1911, Lord Hardinge revoked the division of Bengal.
- It was done in response to the Swadeshi movement's riots in protest against the policy.
- The partition animated the Muslims to form their own national organization along communal lines.

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Hindu-Muslim Unity



Deshbondhu
Chittaranjan Das

Government of India Act 1935

Indian Councils Act

Indian Councils Act 1861:

The Indian Councils Act 1861 was an Act of the Parliament of the United Kingdom that transformed India's executive council to function as a cabinet run on the portfolio system. It was introduced because the British Government wanted to involve the Indian people with the process of law making. This Act was passed on 1st August 1861.

Main provisions of the Act:

-
  - It made a **beginning of representative institutions** by associating Indians with law-making
  - Viceroy nominated some **Indians as non-official members** of his **expanded council**
  - **Restored legislative making powers of Bombay and Madras**
  - Establishment of **new Legislative councils** for **Bengal, North-Western Frontier Province and Punjab**

Drawbacks of the Act:

- The biggest drawback of the Act was regarding the **selection and the role of the Additional Members.**
- These members did **not take part in the discussions and their role was only advisory.**
- The Indian members were **not eligible to oppose any bill** and most often the bills were passed in **one sitting without discussion.**

Indian Councils Act 1892:

The Indian Councils Act 1892 was an Act of British Parliament that introduced various amendments to the **composition and function of legislative councils in British India.** Most notably, the act **expanded the number of members in the central and provincial councils.**

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Khilafat and Non-cooperation Movement

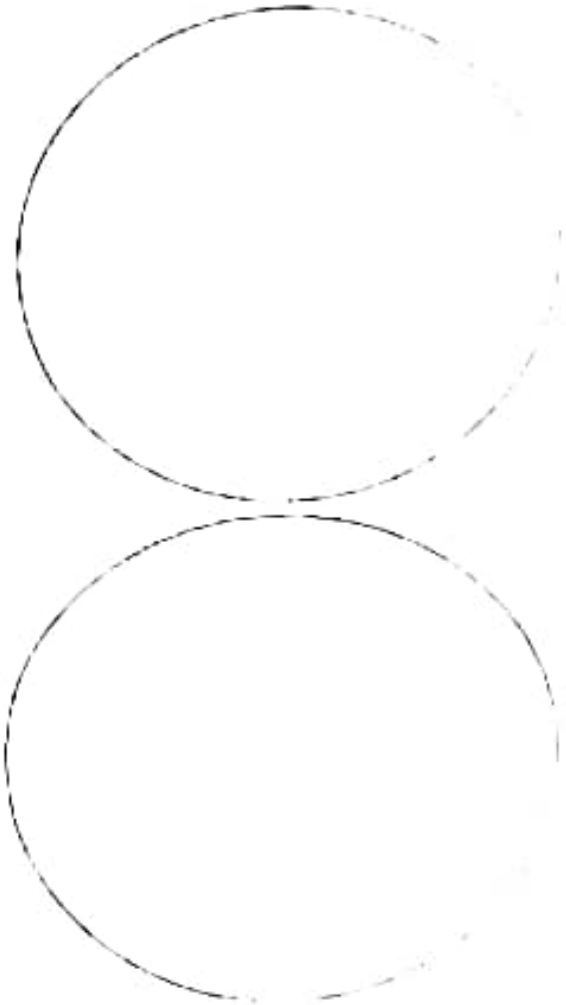
Rowlatt Act and Jalianwallah Bagh massacre sparked Satyagraha

Dismemberment of Ottoman Empire by British angered Muslims; Khilafat movement

Gandhi supported Khilafat cause to enlist Muslim support

Gandhi linked issues of of Swaraj (Self-Government) with the Khilafat demands at Nagpur Congress Session (1920)

Non cooperation plan adopted at the session which aimed to resist British occupation



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The Communal Award was by the British Prime Minister Ramsay Macdonald on 16 August 1932





The Government of India Act 1935 passed in August 1935

Limited self-rule is achieved

Krishak-Praja Party(KPP)

Demands of KPP

- abolition of the zamindari system
- peasants' absolute proprietorship of land
- reduction of land rent rate
- giving interest free loans to peasants
- creating irrigation facilities; digging canals
- introduction of free primary education, etc.

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(d) The primary aim of the hunter commission is to look into the state of primary education in India, but the commission decided to look into secondary and higher education in India as well.

British Inclination towards Muslims

Mohammedan Literary Society

- **Mohammedan Literary Society** was founded by **Nawab Abdul Latif** in Kolkata in 1863. He himself was its secretary and his residence at 16 Taltala (Calcutta) was its head office.
- The management committee of the society was formed with Prince Mahomed Ruheemoodin of Mysore (Karnataka, India) as President, and Prince Mirza Jahan Kader Bahadur of Oudh and Prince Mahomed Nusseroodin Hyder of Mysore as Vice-Presidents.
- The Lieutenant Governor of Bengal was made the Patron of the Society. More than 500 Muslims from all parts of India joined the society as ordinary members. Deliberations in the monthly meetings were held in Urdu, Persian, Arabic and English languages.
- **Objectives: (a)** The Society was established, 'to educate the Muslims in western learning through English medium and to prepare them equal to the educated Hindus and the English men in social intercourse.

  (b) With this end in view, he arranged meetings for discussion on various subjects such as science, arts and living issues, and to find out ways and means for the expansion of Muslim education.

  (c) The society worked to restore the self-confidence that was eroding faster among the Muslims and to initiate a new phase of social development by introducing modern education and intellectual discussions in order to establish a dependable bridge between the rulers and the ruled.

  (d) So the establishment of the society, the first Muslim institution of its kind, in course of time produced great internal as well as external benefits.
- In 1865 a large gathering was held in the Calcutta Town Hall in which the Lt Governor of Bengal was the chief guest. About two thousand delegates - Muslims, Hindus, Christians and Jews - attended the meeting.
- Soon the Society became a meeting-place of distinguished scholars and learned persons. The Maharaja of Indore, the Begum of Bhopal, the Rajas of Jaipur, Patiala and Kuch-Bihar attended as guests of honour in meetings of the Society.
- Through his tireless efforts, **Nawab Abdool Luteef** made the Mohammedan Literary Society a powerful forum for the social, cultural and intellectual progress of Muslims.
- It survived as the most important nerve centre of the Muslims of Bengal down to 1930 under the name of the Muslim Institute of Calcutta.

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Young Bengal Movement

- An intellectual and cultural movement by young adult influenced by **Henry Louis**, a [illegible] based on Kolkata Hindu College. They have raised questions against [illegible] and institutions
- Krishnamohan Bandyopadhyay, Rashik Krishna Mallik, Dakhinaranjan Mukhopadhyay, Ramgopal Ghose are one of the great followers of Henry Louis. They were challenged many Hindu religious culture and practice and even some of them left Hinduism.

Doctrine of Lapse – Final Wave of Annexations by Lord Dalhousie

The Doctrine of Lapse was introduced by Lord Dalhousie (1848 to 1856)

As per Doctrine of Lapse, the Kingdom would 'Lapse' and would become part of British East India Company territory if the ruler of a Kingdom died without male heir.

Doctrine of Lapse – Different Kingdoms that were Annexed

Through Doctrine of Lapse many Kingdoms were annexed which are given below:

The Kingdom of Satara was the 1st kingdom to be annexed through the Doctrine of Lapse in 1848.

The Kingdom of Sambalpur was annexed in 1850.

The Kingdom of Udaipur was annexed by Dalhousie through the Doctrine of Lapse in 1852.

The Kingdom of Nagpur was annexed in 1853.

The Kingdom of Jhansi was annexed in 1854.

The final annexation through the Doctrine of Lapse was the Kingdom of Awadh in 1856.

Fakir-Sannyasi Resistance (1760-1790)

- **Fakir-Sannyasi Resistance** an armed resistance of the combined body of Muslim fakirs (sufis) and Hindu sannyasis (yogis) against the dominance of the English East India Company in Bengal. This resistance began in 1760 and continued for more than four decades.
- The Fakir-Sannyasi Resistance movement was organised and led by Majnu shah and Bhabani Pathak with many of them followers.
- The peasant also supported the Fakir-Sannayasi as they also exploited by different land and Tax rules
- In most case they attacked suddenly and their main target was the Company kuthi (house), revenue kachans (house) of zamindars loyal to the Company rulers, and the houses of their officials

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- The rebellion saw the end of the 's rule in India.
- In August, by the , the company was formally dissolved and its ruling powers over India were transferred to the British Crown.
- A new British government department, the , was created to handle the governance of India, and its head, the , was entrusted with formulating Indian policy.
- The Governor-General of India gained a new title, , and implemented the policies devised by the India Office.

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Notes for Lecture three by Md Abdul Malak, PhD

- The **Revolt of 1857** was not simply a Sepoy Mutiny; it was a manifestation of the accumulated wrath, fury, and grievances of the Indian people against British rule.
- It was obvious that there needed to be a change in the way people were managed.
- As a consequence, the British government made the decision to dissolve the East India Company and take direct control of India.
- India was under Crown Rule from 1858 to 1947.

The Crown rule 1858

- **Crown Rule**, also known as British Raj or Direct rule in India, was the British Crown's rule over the Indian subcontinent from 1858 to 1947.
- The British administration ruled India1858 till India gained independence in 1947.
- This system of government was put into place on June 28, 1858, when Queen Victoria, who had been crowned Empress (সম্রাজ্ঞী) of India in 1876.
- The Province of Bengal was the hub of India's independence movement against British rule during the Crown Rule [1858 - 1947],

Hunter Commission

- Hunter Commission officially known as the Indian Education Commission, 1882, was the first education commission in the history of modern India.
- Presided over by Sir william wilson hunter, a Bengal Civilian, the Commission included ananda mohan bose, AW Croft (Director of Public Instruction, Bengal), bhudev mukhopadhyay, Maharaja Jatindra Mohan Tagore, Kashinath Trimbak Teelang and Sayed Ahmad Khan who later withdrew in favour of his son Sayed Mahmad.
- The Commission submitted its report in October 1883 and its thirty-six recommendations.
- Objectives:
  - (a) To assess the state of education in India with special emphasis on primary education and give suggestions for its improvement.
  - (b) To assess the work of religious missionaries in the field of education.
  - (c) To decide if the government should be allowed to continue to provide education to the messes.

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